

Ying Xu

Curriculum Vitae

Updated June 16, 2026

Ph.D. Student, Special Education
Department of Educational Psychology
College of Education and Human Development
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research focuses on the early identification of and intervention for students with or at risk for reading disabilities. I am particularly interested in examining the long-term effect of reading instruction and the factors associated with the persistence and fadeout of instructional effects using meta-analytic approaches. I also investigate how assessment and measurement approaches (e.g., classification accuracy, reader profiles, and eye-tracking-based measures) inform educational decision-making.

EDUCATION

2023-present	Ph.D. Student, Texas A&M University Major: Special Education
2020-2023	Ph.D. Student, Texas A&M University Major: Bilingual Education In 2023, I transferred to the Special Education program.
2012-2014	M.Ed., Texas A&M University Major: Bilingual Education
2008-2012	B.A., Anqing Normal University, China Major: English Education

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2023-present	Graduate Researcher, Texas A&M University Advisor: Dr. Florina Erbeli • Lead meta-analytic research on the long-term effects of reading instruction and contribute to work on the persistence of intervention effects. • Apply statistical methods (e.g., robust variance estimation, meta-regression) to multiple research initiatives. • Lead manuscript preparation and conference submissions. • Lead project management, study design, and data collection and curation. • Collaborate with and provide guidance to junior lab members on research tasks and project workflows.
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- 2023-present Graduate Researcher, Texas A&M University
Neurobiological Lab for Learning and Development (NLD)
Advisor: Dr. Steven Woltering
- Design and implement studies using eye-tracking methods to examine cognitive processes underlying reading and reading difficulties.
 - Contribute to experimental design, data collection, and data analysis.
 - Contribute to conference proposal preparation and dissemination of research findings.
- 2021-2023 Graduate Research Assistant, Texas A&M University
Center for Research and Development in Dual Language and Literacy Acquisition (CRDLLA)
Advisors: Dr. Rafael Lara-Alecio, Dr. Beverly Irby, Dr. Fuhui Tong
- Applied statistical methods (e.g., confirmatory factor analysis) to multiple large-scale research projects on bilingual education and literacy-infused science instruction.
 - Contributed to preparation of grant reports and grant applications.
 - Supported project coordination and teacher professional development.
 - Led preparation and submission of a conference proposal.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- 2023-present Graduate Assistant and Teaching Assistant
Texas A&M University
- 2020-2021 Lecturer
University of Science and Technology of China, China
- 2016-2020 Program Coordinator, Academic Coach
Xinhua Education Group Limited, China
- 2014-2016 General Education Teacher
Kindergarten, Madison Elementary, ISD 742, St Cloud, MN
- 2012-2014 Chinese Enrichment Program Teacher
Fourth Grade, Johnson Elementary, Bryan ISD, Bryan, TX
- 2011-2021 Program Coordinator, Teacher (Part-time)
Lead Learner Educational and Technology Group, China

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Published

- Erbeli, F., Rice, M., **Xu, Y.**, & Savage, R. (2026). Effect size thresholds in early literacy: Defining benchmarks for phonemic awareness research. *Early Education and Development*, 37(3), 604–621. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10409289.2025.2581998>
- Erbeli, F., Rice, M., **Xu, Y.**, Bishop, M. E., & Goodrich, J. M. (2024). A meta-analysis on the optimal cumulative dosage of early phonemic awareness instruction. *Scientific Studies*

of Reading, 28(4), 345–370. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10888438.2024.2309386>

Quiñonez-Beltran, J., Seymour, T., Robbins, J., **Xu, Y.**, & Joshi, R. M. (2024). What can eye movements tell us about reading in a second language: A scoping review of the literature. *Education Sciences*, 14(4), 375–401.
<https://doi.org/10.3390/educsci14040375>

Holtz, E., Li, X., **Xu, Y.**, & Grice, S. (2022). Self-care amongst doctoral students: A pilot study of domestic and international students in Texas public universities. *International Journal of Doctoral Studies*, 17, 533–552.
<https://doi.org/10.28945/5046>

Under Review

Xu, Y., & Erbeli, F. (revise & resubmit). Long-term effects of reading instruction on reading outcomes: A meta-analysis.

Stalega, M. V., Erbeli, F., **Xu, Y.**, & Kearns, D. M. (revise & resubmit). Optimizing time in isolated phonemic awareness instruction: A meta-analysis of cumulative dosage for improved reading outcomes.

Maddock, J. E., Yeh, S., & **Xu, Y.** (revise & resubmit). Development and validation of scales of perceived environment and social support to time spent in nature (TSN).

Erbeli, F., & **Xu, Y.** (under review). Machine learning for causal inference in child psychology: The effect of using letters in phonemic awareness instruction on reading outcomes.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Erbeli, F., & **Xu, Y.** (2026, September 1-3). *Long-term effects of reading instruction on reading outcomes: A meta-analysis of follow-up impacts and fadeout*. In K. Landerl (Chair). Written language processing: Developmental trajectories, verbal fact learning, and long-term instruction effects [Paper presentation]. Future Education Conference 2026: Interdisciplinary Research Perspectives, Graz, Austria. (International) <https://future-education.uni-graz.at/en/conference/>

Xu, Y., Marek, K., Goodrich, J. M., & Erbeli, F. (2026, July 16-18). *How accurately does Istation classify the risk status of third-grade ELL students based on STAAR performance?* [Poster presentation]. 33rd Annual Meeting, Society for Scientific Studies of Reading, Rotterdam, The Netherlands. (International)
<https://www.triplesr.org/sssr-thirty-third-annual-conference>

Erbeli, F., & **Xu, Y.** (2026, July 16-18). *Persistence and fadeout of reading intervention gains over time*. [Poster presentation]. 33rd Annual Meeting, Society for Scientific Studies of Reading, Rotterdam, The Netherlands. (International)

<https://www.triplesr.org/sss三十-third-annual-conference>

Pazoki, S., Quinonez-Beltran, J., **Xu, Y.**, & Woltering, S. (2026, July 16-18). *From fixations to recall: Linking eye movements to novel-word processing and acquisition in native and non-native readers*. [Paper presentation]. 33rd Annual Meeting, Society for Scientific Studies of Reading, Rotterdam, The Netherlands. (International) <https://www.triplesr.org/sss三十-third-annual-conference>

Erbeli, F., & **Xu, Y.** (2026, July 6-8). *Persistence and fadeout of reading intervention gains over time*. [Paper presentation]. 24th European Conference on Literacy, Ljubljana, Slovenia. (International) <https://www.literacyeurope.org/ljubljana-2026/>

Erbeli, F., **Xu, Y.**, & Liew, J. (2026, May 28-30). *Meta-analytic evidence shows partial persistence of reading intervention gains on reading outcomes?* [Poster presentation] 2026 Association for Psychological Science Annual Convention, Barcelona, Spain. (International) <https://www.psychologicalscience.org/conventions/2026-aps-annual-convention>

Xu, Y., Marek, K., & Erbeli, F. (2026, February 4-6). *How well does Istation classify 3rd-grade ELL students' STAAR outcomes?* [Poster presentation] 34th Annual Pacific Coast Research Conference (PCRC), Long Beach, CA, USA. (International) <https://pcrc.sites.stanford.edu/>

Erbeli, F., & **Xu, Y.** (2026, February 4-6). *Do reading intervention gains last? Evidence of partial persistence and fadeout*. [Poster presentation]. 34th Annual Pacific Coast Research Conference (PCRC), Long Beach, CA, USA. (International) <https://pcrc.sites.stanford.edu/>

Erbeli, F., & **Xu, Y.** (2026, January 16-17). *How long do reading gains hold? Meta-analytic evidence of fadeout trajectories* [Paper presentation]. International Conference on Education, Language, and Teaching, Zurich, Switzerland. (International) <https://theiier.org/Conference/26468/ICELT/>

Xu, Y., & Erbeli, F. (2025, October 8-11). *Long-term effects of reading instruction on reading outcomes: A meta-analysis*. [Poster presentation]. Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE) 2025 Conference, Chicago, IL, USA. (International) <https://www.sree.org>

Erbeli, F., Stalega, M., **Xu, Y.**, & Savage, R. (2025, October 8-11). *Establishing effect size thresholds for phonemic awareness research on reading outcomes*. [Poster presentation]. Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE) 2025 Conference, Chicago, IL, USA. (International) <https://www.sree.org>

Xu, Y., & Erbeli, F. (2025, July 16-19). *A meta-analysis of the follow-up effects of reading instruction*. [Poster presentation]. 32nd Annual Meeting, Society for Scientific Studies of Reading (SSSR), Calgary, Canada. (International) <https://www.triplesr.org>

- Erbeli, F., Rice, M., **Xu, Y.**, & Savage, R. (2025, July 16-19). *Effect size thresholds for phonemic awareness research*. [Poster presentation]. 32nd Annual Meeting, Society for Scientific Studies of Reading (SSSR), Calgary, Canada. (International) <https://www.triplesr.org>
- Xu, Y.**, & Erbeli, F. (2025, February 5-7). *Long-term effects of reading instruction on reading outcomes: A meta-analysis*. [Poster presentation]. 33rd Annual Pacific Coast Research Conference (PCRC), Coronado, CA, USA. (International) <https://pcrc.sites.stanford.edu/>
- Erbeli, F., Rice, M., **Xu, Y.**, & Savage, R. (2025, February 5-7). *Time to redefine effect size thresholds for phonemic awareness research?* [Poster presentation]. 33rd Annual Pacific Coast Research Conference (PCRC), Coronado, CA, USA. (International) <https://pcrc.sites.stanford.edu/>
- Bishop, M. E. & **Xu, Y.** (2024, October 24-26). *Let them play while learning to write: Embedding motor activities into handwriting instruction*. [Poster presentation]. International Dyslexia Association (IDA) 2024 Annual Reading, Literacy, and Learning Conference, Dallas, TX, USA. (International) <https://dyslexiacon.org>
- Xu, Y.**, Lee-Cobbins, A., & Erbeli, F. (2024, October 24-26). *Characteristics of students with dyslexia in special education research: A systematic review*. [Poster presentation]. International Dyslexia Association (IDA) 2024 Annual Reading, Literacy, and Learning Conference, Dallas, TX, USA. (International) <https://dyslexiacon.org>
- Pazoki, S., **Xu, Y.**, Quinonez-Beltran, J., & Woltering, S. (2024, August 8-10). *What eye movements reveal about incidental vocabulary learning in emotional reading contexts*. [Poster presentation]. 2024 Annual Meeting, American Psychological Association (APA), Seattle, WA, USA. (International) <https://www.apa.org>
- Erbeli, F., Lee-Cobbins, A., Rice, M., **Xu, Y.**, Bishop, M. E., & Goodrich, J. M. (2024, July 10-13). *Phonemic awareness instruction in pre-K through first grade: How much is enough?* [Poster presentation]. 31st Annual Meeting, Society for Scientific Studies of Reading (SSSR), Copenhagen, Denmark. (International) <https://www.triplesr.org>
- Quinonez-Beltran, J., Seymour, T., Robbins, J., **Xu, Y.**, & Joshi, J. M. (2024, July 10-13). *What can eye movements tell us about reading in a second language? A systematic review of the literature*. [Poster presentation]. 31st Annual Meeting, Society for Scientific Studies of Reading (SSSR), Copenhagen, Denmark. (International) <https://www.triplesr.org>
- Xu, Y.**, Ma, S., Lara-Alecio, R., Irby, B., Tong, F., & Guerrero, C. (2024, April 11-14). *Development and validation of the instrument of Motivated Strategies in Science Learning (MSSL)*. [Paper session]. American Educational Research Association (AERA) 2024 Annual Conference, Philadelphia, PA, USA. (International)

<https://www.aera.net>

Lai, J., Yang, X., **Xu, Y.**, & Luo, W. (2024, April 11-14). *The mediation of interpersonal skills between executive functioning and reading achievement among first-grade emerging bilinguals*. [Paper session]. American Educational Research Association (AERA) 2024 Annual Conference, Philadelphia, PA, USA. (International) <https://www.aera.net>

Xu, Y., & Erbeli, F. (2024, March 13-16). *Characteristics of individuals with specific learning disabilities: A review*. [Poster presentation] Council for Exceptional Children (CEC) 2024 Convention & Expo, San Antonio, TX, USA. (International) <https://cecconvention.org>

Erbeli, F., Rice, M., **Xu, Y.**, Bishop, M. E., & Goodrich, J. M. (2024, March 13-16). *A meta-analysis on the optimal dosage of phonemic awareness instruction*. [Poster presentation] Council for Exceptional Children (CEC) 2024 Convention & Expo, San Antonio, TX, USA. (International) <https://cecconvention.org>

Erbeli, F., **Xu, Y.**, Rice, M., & Goodrich, J. M. (2023, November 24-26). *How much phonemic awareness instruction is enough?* [Poster presentation]. International Education Conference, Vienna, Austria. (International) <https://www.ieconf.org>

Erbeli, F., **Xu, Y.**, Rice, M., & Goodrich, J. M. (2023, May 25). *How much phonemic awareness instruction is enough?* [Poster presentation]. 2023 Texas Association for the Education of Young Children Annual Childhood Conference, Bryan, TX, USA. (State) <https://texasaeyc.org>

Lara-Alecio, R., Irby, B., Tong, F., Tang, S., Guerrero, C., Wang, Z., **Xu, Y.**, & Ma, S. (2023, April 15). *The impact of literacy-infused science intervention on students' science learning and motivation during COVID-19 crisis*. [Paper session] American Educational Research Association (AERA) Annual Conference, Chicago, IL, USA. (International) <https://www.aera.net>

Tang, S., Lara-Alecio, R., Irby, B., Tong, F., Guerrero, C., Zhang, H., Ma, S., & **Xu, Y.** (2023, April 15). *A comparison study of teachers' pedagogical practices in online and in-person classes*. [Roundtable session] American Educational Research Association (AERA) Annual Conference, Chicago, IL, USA. (International) <https://www.aera.net>

ADDITIONAL RESEARCH DISSEMINATION

Cited Erbeli et al. (2024) article (<https://doi.org/10.1080/10888438.2024.2309386>)

- Terada, Y., & Merrill, S. (2024, December 6). *The 10 most significant education studies of 2024*. Edutopia. <https://www.edutopia.org/article/the-10-most-significant-education-studies-of-2024>

- Research Features. (2024, May 17). *Teaching early phonemic awareness: Is there a magic number of hours?* Research Features. <https://researchfeatures.com/teaching-early-phonemic-awareness/>
- Wang, Q., & Will, K. (2024, February 29). Research article of the month: February 2024. *Iowa Reading Research Center Blog*. <https://irrc.education.uiowa.edu/blog/2024/02/research-article-month-february-2024>
- Marshall, K., Marshall Memo (2024, February 27). *The goldilocks amount of phonemic awareness in primary grades*. [Press release]. <https://www.marshallmemo.com/>
- Today Headline (2024, February 26). *As schools embrace the science of reading, researchers are criticizing an overemphasis on auditory skills*. [Press release]. <https://hechingerreport.org/as-schools-embrace-the-science-of-reading-researchers-are-critizing-an-overemphasis-on-auditory-skills>
- Barshay, J., Hechinger Report (2024, February 26). *PROOF POINTS: Controversies within the science of reading. A growing number of researchers are criticizing an overemphasis on auditory skills*. [Press release]. <https://hechingerreport.org/proof-points-controversies-within-the-science-of-reading/#:~:text=Researchers%20worried%20that%20educators%20were,was%20being%20taught%20in%20schools>
- Downs, J. D. (Host). (2024, February 15). *E48| Phonemic Awareness: Unpacking recent meta-analysis findings with Dr. Florina Erbeli and Dr. Marianne Rice*. *Teaching Literacy Podcast*. [Audio podcast]. <https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/e48-phonemic-awareness-unpacking-recent-meta-analysis/id1482475731?i=1000645474424>
- Schwarz, S. E. Education Week (2024, February 9). *How much time should teachers spend on a foundational reading skill? Research offers clues*. [Press release]. <https://www.edweek.org/teaching-learning/how-much-time-should-teachers-spend-on-a-foundational-reading-skill-research-offers-clues/2024/02>
- Borkowskey, F., & Boksner, J. (Hosts). (2024, January 25). *What should phonemic awareness instruction look like? The Literacy View Podcast*. [Audio podcast]. <https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/what-should-pa-instruction-look-like-tiffany-peltier/id1614519794?i=1000643503691>

AWARDS, HONORS, & RESEARCH SUPPORT

- 2026 Texas A&M University, College of Education and Human Development
Graduate Research Award (\$1,000)
 College-level award recognizing research potential and supporting an independent research project.
- 2026 Council for Exceptional Children, Division for Research (CEC-DR)
Student Research Award (\$300)
 International-level award recognizing high-quality graduate student research in special education.

- 2025 Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE)
Conference Attendance Grant (\$750)
International-level travel grant supporting presentation at the SREE 2025 Annual Conference.
- 2025 Texas A&M University, College of Education and Human Development
Dean's Graduate Award (\$2,000)
College-level award recognizing research potential and supporting research endeavors.
- 2025 Society for Scientific Studies of Reading (SSSR)
Taylor & Francis Award
International-level award for promising young researchers.
- 2025 Texas A&M University, College of Education and Human Development, Department of Educational Psychology, Special Education Program
Student Conference Travel Award (\$500)
Program-level travel award supporting presentation at the SSSR 2025 Annual Meeting.
- 2025 Texas A&M University, College of Education and Human Development
Graduate Research Award (\$1,000)
College-level award recognizing research potential and supporting an independent research project.
- 2024 International Dyslexia Association (IDA)
Advocate Scholarship
International-level travel scholarship supporting presentation at the IDA 2024 Annual Conference.
- 2024 Texas A&M University
International Texas Public Education Grant (\$1,000)
State-level grant awarded to international students with demonstrated academic achievement.
- 2024 Texas A&M University, Graduate and Professional School
Graduate Student Research and Presentation Travel Award (\$750)
University-level travel award supporting presentation at the SSSR 2024 Annual Meeting.
- 2024 Texas A&M University
International Education Fee Scholarship (\$1,000)
University-level scholarship for international students in recognition of achievement in academics, leadership, and service.
- 2023 Texas A&M University, College of Education and Human Development, Department

of Educational Psychology, Special Education Program

Student Conference Travel Award (\$285)

Program-level travel award supporting presentation at the CEC 2024 Convention & Expo.

2020 Texas A&M University, College of Education and Human Development, Department of Educational Psychology

Graduate Scholarship

Department-level scholarship in recognition of achievements in research, teaching, and service.

2020 Texas A&M University, College of Education and Human Development, Department of Educational Psychology, Bilingual and English as a Second Language Program

Competitive Scholarship

Program-level scholarship in recognition of academic achievements and potential.

SERVICE

2026 Texas A&M University
Applicant Review Committee for a Postdoctoral Researcher in Erbeli Lab, Special Education Program

2024-present Texas A&M University
Graduate eFolio Evaluation Committee, Special Education Master's Program

2024 Texas A&M University
Applicant Review Committee, Special Education Doctoral Program

2023-present Texas A&M University
Applicant Review Committee, Special Education Master's Program

2019 Community
Parent Association for Children with Special Needs, Hefei, China

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

2026 Texas A&M University
Teaching Assistant Institute (TAI) Certificate

2024 Texas A&M University
Advanced Research Methods (ARM) Certificate

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

2024-present International Literacy Association (ILA)

2023-present Society for the Scientific Study of Reading (SSSR)

2023-present Council for Exceptional Children (CEC)

2025-2026 Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE)

2023-2025 American Psychological Association (APA)

2022-2024 American Educational Research Association (AERA)

2020-2023 TESOL International Association (TESOL)

TEACHING CERTIFICATION

2012-present Ministry of Education, China
 High School English Teacher Qualification